

Yassine RACHIDY

PhD Student | LLM Safety & Alignment

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ABOUT

PhD student at UM6P working on LLM safety and alignment. Currently focusing on mechanistic interpretability of LLM safety mechanisms and on translating those insights into more reliable defenses.

EDUCATION

PhD Student <i>AI Movement, University Mohammed VI Polytechnic (UM6P)</i>	2024 – Present Rabat, Morocco
- Supervised by Prof. Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni and Dr. Youssef Hmamouche - Research Focus: LLM Safety, Alignment, and Mechanistic Interpretability.	
Pre-doctoral Student <i>AI Movement, University Mohammed VI Polytechnic (UM6P)</i>	2023 – 2024 Rabat, Morocco
MEng in Data & Software Engineering <i>National Institute of Statistics and Applied Economics (INSEA)</i>	Graduated 2023 Rabat, Morocco

PUBLICATIONS

Strategic Deflection: Defending LLMs from Logit Manipulation <i>Computational Linguistics, To be Presented at EMNLP 2026</i>	2026
- Introduced a novel defense mechanism against jailbreaking attacks that strategically redirects harmful queries when refusals fail, demonstrating significant reduction in Attack Success Rate (ASR) while maintaining performance on benign tasks. - Mechanistically characterized the defense via token-level entropy dynamics and latent trajectory probing, confirming deflection operates representationally rather than through surface-level lexical patterns.	
Domain Adaptive Document Reranking for Retrieval Augmented Generation <i>37th International Conference on Tools with Artificial Intelligence (ICTAI)</i>	2025
- Engineered a novel Mixture of Experts (MoE) reranker architecture to efficiently handle multi-domain adaptability, achieving superior performance over LLM-based and commercial models without the cost of deploying multiple specialized models. - Designed an LLM-based data generation pipeline to address the scarcity of labeled datasets for reranker fine-tuning.	

SKILLS

Languages
English (Professional), French (Professional), Arabic (Native)

Technical Skills
LLM Safety & Alignment (preference optimization, adversarial robustness, jailbreak attack design and evaluation) · Mechanistic Interpretability (sparse autoencoders, causal intervention, linear probing, residual stream analysis) · ML Engineering.